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TRAINING SYSTEM 02

The Corporate Workout Plan

A four-day strength programme for people with unpredictable calendars. Heavy sets, full 2–4 minute rests, gym or home — built so that missing a day doesn't break the week.

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Train for a calendar you don't control

Most programmes assume you'll show up on the days they tell you to. Yours has to survive a 9pm deployment, a Bangalore-Mumbai flight and a mother-in-law visit. This one does.

The design principle is **rotation, not schedule**. There are four workouts — A, B, C, D. You do them in order whenever you get to the gym. Miss Tuesday? Tuesday's workout just happens on Wednesday. Nothing is ever "missed," it's only delayed. Over a month you'll average 3–4 sessions a week without ever feeling behind.

THE FLOOR

Two sessions a week maintains everything you build. Three grows steadily. Four is optimal. On your worst weeks, protect the floor of two — that's what stops the six-month restart cycle.

How to load every set

- **Reps in reserve (RIR):** stop each set with 2 reps left in the tank. That's hard enough to grow, easy enough to repeat tomorrow.
- **Progress by weight, then reps:** hit the top of the rep range on all sets? Add 2.5 kg next session and drop back to the bottom of the range.
- **Rest 2–4 minutes between every set.** Nearer 4 on squats, deadlifts and presses; nearer 2 on isolation work. Start the timer the moment you rack the bar and don't lift again until it goes off.
- **Log it.** Notes app is fine. Untracked training is just exercise.

WHY THE LONG RESTS

Short rests feel productive and cost you strength. Your muscles need roughly **2–4 minutes** to restore the energy system that drives heavy sets — cut it to 60 seconds and set two, three and four all land lighter than they should. Longer rests mean more weight on the bar, and weight on the bar is what actually drives the change.

Budget **60–70 minutes** per session. If you only have 45, cut the last two exercises — never cut the rest.

The four workouts

Workout A — Lower body (push emphasis)

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Notes
Goblet or back squat	4 × 6–8	Full depth over heavy weight
Romanian deadlift	3 × 8–10	Feel it in the hamstrings, not the lower back
Walking lunge	3 × 10 per leg	Fixes the desk-job hip imbalance
Leg curl or Nordic negative	3 × 10–12	Knee insurance
Standing calf raise	3 × 12–15	Pause 1 second at the top
Plank	3 × 45 sec	Ribs down, glutes on

Workout B — Upper body (push emphasis)

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Notes
Incline dumbbell press	4 × 8–10	Best chest builder for desk posture
Seated shoulder press	3 × 8–10	Stop if the shoulder pinches
Chest-supported row	4 × 10–12	Yes, rows on push day. You need the volume.
Cable lateral raise	3 × 12–15	Width is what makes a shirt fit
Triceps rope pushdown	3 × 12–15	
Face pull	3 × 15	The single best anti-desk exercise

The four workouts (continued)

Workout C — Lower body (hinge emphasis)

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Notes
Trap-bar or conventional deadlift	4 × 5	Technique first. Always.
Bulgarian split squat	3 × 8 per leg	Brutal. Worth it.
Hip thrust	3 × 10–12	Glutes switch off after 8 hours of sitting
Leg extension	3 × 12–15	
Hanging knee raise	3 × 12	

Workout D — Upper body (pull emphasis)

Exercise	Sets × Reps	Notes
Pull-up or lat pulldown	4 × 6–10	Use bands if you can't do 5 yet
One-arm dumbbell row	3 × 10 per side	
Flat dumbbell press	3 × 8–10	
Rear delt fly	3 × 15	Rounds out the shoulder
Barbell or hammer curl	3 × 10–12	
Farmer's carry	3 × 40 m	Grip, core and traps in one

No gym? No excuse.

Every workout above has a hotel-room and living-room version. Swap the exercise, keep the slot.

Gym exercise	Home / hotel substitute
Back squat	Goblet squat with a suitcase, or 1.5-rep bodyweight squat
Deadlift	Single-leg RDL (bodyweight, slow)
Incline press	Feet-elevated push-up, 3-second lower
Row / pulldown	Resistance-band row (pack one — it weighs 200 g)
Lateral raise	Band lateral raise or water-bottle raise
Hip thrust	Single-leg glute bridge, 15 per side

BUY THIS ONE THING

A set of resistance bands costs under ₹1,000, fits in a laptop bag, and removes travel as an excuse permanently. It is the highest-ROI fitness purchase an Indian professional can make.

The 12-week arc

- **Weeks 1–2:** Learn the movements. Deliberately leave 3–4 reps in reserve. You should finish feeling like you could do more — that's correct.
- **Weeks 3–8:** Push weight up every session where you can. This is where the visible change happens.
- **Week 9:** Deload — same exercises, two-thirds of the weight, half the sets. Your joints will thank you.
- **Weeks 10–12:** Push again, then retest your top sets against week 3.

Before you start

- ☐ Booked the four sessions into your work calendar as blocked time
- ☐ Gym bag packed the night before, kept at the door
- ☐ Notes app opened with the four workouts saved
- ☐ Decided your two "floor" days — the ones you'll protect no matter what

The only rule that matters

Never miss twice. One missed session is a scheduling problem. Two in a row is how a habit dies. If you skip today, the next workout is tomorrow — even if it's a cut-down version. Drop exercises, never drop the rest between sets.